

Lag structures were built at 1, 3, 6, and 12 months for the target variable and key exogenous variables. This design reflects the transmission mechanism in the hackathon brief: oil and shipping costs can influence import costs, then wholesale and retail food prices with a delay. The model therefore uses lags to capture both persistence in inflation and delayed pass-through from global economic conditions to Botswana food inflation. The final feature set is designed to justify the causal story rather than simply concatenating variables into a generic table.

Model Comparison Report